

Working-session *synthesis*

Meeting #4 · June 17, 2026 — the backbone made real.

Meeting #4 · Wednesday June 17, 2026 Present: Mario Ramos (Chairperson), Pedro Rosa (Facilitator), and committee members present — including Munchie and the crew's younger liaison. **Format:** Recorded working session at the gym, intended to be fed back into the canon knowledge repo.

TL;DR

This was the session where the operational backbone went from planned to real. The LLC's Chase account is open, the domain **lafamilia.community** was chosen, and a Google Workspace is being stood up for email and secure document storage. With those rails in place, the committee greenlit and scoped the **public donor-facing site** — distinct from the internal pages built so far — and confirmed the gift model with a fundraising thermometer and an opt-in donor wall. A **fourth initiative** emerged: sponsoring two of the young men's school trip to Washington (formalwear via a controlled-spend mechanism). The college visit got a concrete runway (float to the young men June 18, lock by June 26, travel the week after July 4), the summer trip has a lead location (Mecan River Outfitters & Lodge, WI), and the consent form was simplified for the day-trip college visit. Roughly **\$1,500 is already in hand** without a formal ask, and the target for the next push is about another \$1,500.

1. The operational backbone is now real

The biggest shift since the last session: infrastructure moved from plan to fact.

Banking. The LLC's **Chase account is open** (registered as "L.L.C." with periods, deliberately, for differentiation). It's currently tied to a phone number; Mario will attach the business email and a separate dedicated phone line so gifts can be received cleanly by **Zelle**. The branch manager confirmed Zelle works to either a phone number or an email, and that changing the attached email has to be done in person.

Domain. After working through many candidates, the committee landed on **lafamilia.community** (~\$30/yr via Google Domains). It was chosen because "La Familia Community" is literally the name, it's distinctive, and it's three plain words — no acronym, hyphen, or hard spelling. It's reserved with a short window to reconsider.

Email & storage. Pedro is standing up a **Google Workspace** (~\$8/mo), with himself as admin and Mario added; Mario's workspace email comes first, more added as needed. The Workspace gives the team branded email addresses, **secure cloud storage** for scanning and uploading completed forms, and a shared drive. The plan is to give donors the **email** as the uniform Zelle destination (cleaner than a phone number).

Registered address. The LLC is registered at Pedro's business address (good mailbox and delivery handling).

This domain-plus-email milestone is the trigger we'd been waiting on — it unlocks both the donor site and the path toward broader committee access.

2. The public donor site — greenlit and scoped

A key clarification surfaced in the room: the pages built so far were "*just for our purposes*" — internal. Now the committee wants a **separate, public, donor-facing site**, and there's enough in place to build it. Pedro will build a first version under the new domain and show the committee first.

Scope agreed: – A short **intro/story** — who the committee is (practitioners across different walks of life), where this came from, what they're doing. – The **initiatives** listed (now four — see §3). – A **gift flow**: the donor fills out a short form acknowledging it's a gift (or downloads it), then receives the email address to send a **Zelle** payment; the committee reconciles the incoming Zelle against the form manually and confirms receipt. – A **fundraising thermometer** toward a single overall goal (a deliberately non-round number reads as

diligence — e.g., ~\$4,800). **Decided against** letting donors earmark gifts to specific initiatives for now — too complicated; one thermometer instead. — An opt-in **donor wall** — a scrolling list of who gave and how much, with an **Anonymous** option. Framed as encouragement ("I dig what you're doing"), not bragging.

Reach mechanics: business cards and **QR codes** pointing to the site (so the page can change without reprinting the code); outreach by text, email, and in person. An **Instagram** presence was proposed (Munchie to run it) to show the work in real time with a link in bio to the site — most likely donors are reportedly on Instagram. Facebook was explicitly ruled out.

3. Initiatives — now four

3a. College visit (lead — concrete runway)

- **Float to the young men June 18** at the gym; collect intake info and gauge interest.
- A **same-day** visit (~2-hour drive; Illinois State as the model — campus tour, dorms, lunch). Leave ~7:30 AM to be there by 9.
- **Dates:** the week after July 4. Only July 3 is unavailable at the school; the team will offer two dates (e.g., a Thursday/Friday such as the 9th/10th or 16th/17th, or a Mon/Tue) and let the group pick. Must land **before the young men's July 24–26 Washington trip**.
- **Lock the date by June 26.** Roughly six young men anticipated; two cars.

3b. Summer trip (lead location identified)

- **Mecan River Outfitters & Lodge** (Wisconsin, ~2h40m, near the Dells) is the front-runner — family-owned since 1984, strong reviews, cabins from primitive to lodge (one fits up to ~10 at ~\$130/night), on-site breakfast/lunch/dinner at cost, fire pits and firewood, central showers, and a nearby outfitter for **canoeing/rafting** (drop-off and pickup at river mile markers). Walmart ~30 min away.
- Mario wants to **scout it first** and keep a **backup** location (Starved Rock was discussed as an alternative but is more commercial/strenuous).
- Get a **range of dates** from the young men (alongside the college-visit dates) and set a **budget**.

3c. A game together (still in reserve)

- Unchanged — held until the first initiatives land. A live Chicago game; low cost.

3d. Washington trip sponsorship (NEW)

- A fourth initiative emerged organically: La Familia helps **sponsor two of the young men traveling to Washington** (the July school trip) by covering what they need to be "suited and booted" — polos, a suit, items from the official travel packet (roughly a few hundred dollars).
 - **Spend mechanism (open):** options discussed were funding an **Amazon account directly from the Chase account** (so the young men order from a list and receipts are automatically accounted for) or a reloadable **vanilla gift card**. Either keeps the money controlled and documented. Note: a guardian indicated some extracurricular clothing is already covered by family — the sponsorship is targeted to the formalwear gap.
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4. Consent & intake forms

Intake is in good shape — straightforward capture of contact info, age, the "what sounds good to you" prompt (college visit / trip / ballgame, plus room to brainstorm), and a final line for dates a young person is away. The team will print ~10 for June 18 and also offer a mobile-fillable version.

Consent — simplified for the college visit. The full draft read as a bit heavy for a day trip, so for the college visit specifically Pedro will: — **Merge** general participation and travel authorization into one section with a **single signature** at the bottom (travel is implied by "college visit"). — **Keep** the emergency-medical clause — authorize a designated chaperone to seek treatment if the guardian can't be reached, with the **guardian responsible for any resulting costs**. The committee affirmed this reads as appropriate and legitimizing, and mirrors a standard school field-trip form. Keep a simple allergies/medications/conditions line. — **Reduce media to a disclosure line** at the bottom ("photos/videos may be shared on the website") rather than a separate signed term. — Keep the **overnight-trip addendum separate** — it doesn't apply to the day visit. — Fill in the specific **dates and names** once the visit date is locked.

Background checks — confirmed deferred. The city/CPS background-check-plus-tutorial requirement for chaperones was discussed; the committee is comfortable without it this year given the established relationships, and will reinstate rigor when participation opens to

people they don't know. For the one young person whose parent hasn't been formally met, the committee will **introduce themselves / call the parent** before the trip — kept warm and personal rather than bureaucratic. Idea raised: noting that a **certified EMT** accompanies trips, as a reassurance to parents.

5. Money

- **~\$1,500 already in hand**, with no formal ask yet — described as a strong sign of warm-lead readiness. More warm leads are surfacing (one donor would give more if it were tax-deductible; held to the gift posture for now, with a \$100 gift and others pending the bank setup).
- **Gift posture reaffirmed**: contributions are gifts this year, not tax-deductible donations. The nonprofit path that unlocks write-offs and corporate giving remains the next-year goal.
- **Two-account discipline (intent)**: eventually keep **donor funds in one clean account** (so 100% to the young men is auditable at a glance) and **admin/overhead in a separate fund** (incidentals like food at the park, setup costs). For now Pedro is covering setup costs (domain, Workspace) personally and treating it as part of his contribution.
- **Trip budget**: a 2–3 day trip for the group is estimated around **\$1,000–\$1,600** depending on headcount; the next fundraising push aims to raise roughly another \$1,500. A thermometer goal of ~\$4,800–\$5,000 was floated to cover the slate.

6. Branding & outreach assets

- **Logo**: brainstorm a simple, **scalable** mark (must work on a business card) — motifs discussed include a community circle ("360" as an unbreakable bond), a basketball, "LF," and a scholarship/education theme (a cap/book; "Educando hoy, construyendo mañana"). Sourcing options: **LogoGround** (buy outright with trademark/files, or use for inspiration) and AI generation for adjustments. The logo is assigned to the **young liaison and Juan** to lead.
- **Business cards + QR codes, t-shirts, and stickers** for trips were all floated as low-cost outreach, pointing back to the site.
- **Instagram** (Munchie) for real-time documentation; **Discord** was floated but not decided.

7. Governance & cadence

- Pedro introduced **EOS (the Entrepreneurial Operating System)** as a possible meeting framework — structured L10 meetings, "Rocks," and a scorecard (money in / spent / remaining). Offered as a future adoption, with a book for whoever drives it. Not decided.
- **Cadence**: the group continues weekly; next session next week. Detailed trip logistics (cars, headcount) follow once dates are set.

8. Action items

#	OWNER	ITEM	TARGET
1	Mario / committee	Float the college visit + intake to the young men at the gym	Thu June 18
2	Mario / committee	Collect available dates from the young men (college visit <i>and</i> summer trip)	June 18
3	Mario	Lock the college-visit date	By June 26
4	Mario	Add the business email to the Chase account (Zelle destination)	Near-term
5	Pedro	Stand up Google Workspace (admin + Mario), confirm email live	Near-term
6	Pedro	Set the domain up as a website; build v1 of the public donor site	This week
7	Pedro	Update the consent form for the specific college visit (merge sections, single signature, fill dates/names)	After date locks

#	OWNER	ITEM	TARGET
8	Mario	Scout the Mekan River lodge; identify a backup trip location	Before trip commit
9	Committee	Introduce to / call the one parent not yet formally met, before the visit	Before visit
10	Liaison + Juan	Brainstorm and propose a simple, scalable logo	Ongoing
11	Munchie	Stand up an Instagram presence to document the work	Ongoing
12	Committee	Decide the Washington-sponsorship spend mechanism (Amazon-from-Chase vs. vanilla card)	Before July trip
13	Committee	Reach out to warm leads once the site + bank email are live	After site live

9. Open decisions

1. **Washington-sponsorship mechanism** — Amazon account funded from Chase, or a reloadable vanilla gift card.
2. **Fundraising goal number** for the thermometer (~\$4,800–\$5,000 floated, not set).
3. **Summer-trip dates and budget**, and the backup location.
4. **Whether/when to adopt EOS** for meeting cadence.
5. **Second (admin) account** — when to formally split donor funds from overhead.
6. Carried forward: the scholarship-application return window vs. the fundraising close (Pedro/Mario).

Data-hygiene note. This synthesis deliberately omits the young men's names and the personal and health details that surfaced in casual conversation. Intake, consent, and any sponsorship records will collect personal (and, for minors, guardian) information — that data belongs in the access-controlled Google Workspace storage, not in this markdown record, the canon repo, or any public page.

Staged as plain-text markdown for review. On approval, this can roll into canon and be rendered as a styled working-session PDF wired into the hub, like the May 12, May 19, and June 9 records.